

Compare Sources & Arguments

Workbook 2 - Apply - Focused practice

Directions

Treat each item as close-choice practice. Preserve scope, certainty, and the exact job of each piece of evidence.

Exercise 1

Source A argues for extending bus service permanently because 62 percent of survey respondents want later service. Source B agrees late service may help but notes the survey had a 28 percent response rate and recommends a trial measuring actual ridership.

Task: Which comparison is most accurate?

- A. Both sources reject later service.
- B. Source A emphasizes stated preference; Source B questions whether preference data are sufficient for a permanent decision.
- C. Source B proves nobody wants later service.
- D. Source A and B use identical evidence and reach identical conclusions.

Exercise 2

Source A says a school should replace printed textbooks with tablets because tablets are lighter. Source B notes that weight is a benefit but provides repair-cost and access data showing some students lack reliable home internet.

Task: How does Source B strengthen the discussion?

- A. It adds decision factors that Source A's single benefit does not address.
- B. It proves tablets are always harmful.
- C. It rejects the fact that tablets are lighter.
- D. It discusses an unrelated topic.

Exercise 3

Source A cites one nearby city where a policy succeeded. Source B cites outcomes from twelve cities, including conditions under which the policy failed.

Task: Which argument has stronger comparative support?

- A. Source A, because one example is easier to remember.
- B. Source B, because the broader evidence tests the policy across more conditions and acknowledges limits.
- C. Both are automatically equal because both cite cities.
- D. Neither source can use examples.

Exercise 4

Source A claims a program will save money but gives no cost estimate. Source B gives startup and annual operating costs and identifies where savings would need to occur.

Task: Which statement best explains why Source B is better supported?

- A. It uses more words.
- B. It provides evidence directly related to the financial claim and makes the required tradeoff visible.
- C. It agrees with every reader.
- D. It avoids numbers.

Answer reasoning

Check your reasoning, not only your answer.

For every question, compare your reasoning with the explanation. If you missed the item, identify the exact step where your reasoning changed the source or used evidence for the wrong job.

Exercise 1

Best answer: B. Source A emphasizes stated preference; Source B questions whether preference data are sufficient for a permanent decision.

Why: It captures both the shared issue and the difference in evidence standards.

Exercise 2

Best answer: A. It adds decision factors that Source A's single benefit does not address.

Why: Source B broadens the evidence relevant to the decision without denying the original benefit.

Exercise 3

Best answer: B. Source B, because the broader evidence tests the policy across more conditions and acknowledges limits.

Why: The larger, more varied evidence base better supports a general policy judgment.

Exercise 4

Best answer: B. It provides evidence directly related to the financial claim and makes the required tradeoff visible.

Why: Argument strength comes from relevant support and reasoning, not length or tone.

Mistake check

For every miss, label the reason: wrong claim, evidence mismatch, too broad or too certain, reasoning gap, source or format confusion, or rushed reading. Then write one sentence explaining what you will check next time.